

PRODUCT DOCUMENTATION

Work About Work

Recommendation Logic Map

Document type	Recommendation Content and Ordering Rationale
Version	1.1 (em dashes removed throughout)
Status	Draft
Companion to	Question Bank v1.1
Audience	Internal: product, content, consulting

01

Purpose of This Document

This document records the nine recommendations shown in the Work About Work audit tool: three per score band. It explains why each recommendation was chosen, why it appears in its specific position within the band, and what evidence or established practice backs it. It is the source of truth for anyone updating recommendation copy or extending the tool.

Recommendations are ordered by the question dimension most likely to have produced a high score: moving from the most visible symptom to the underlying cause. A respondent reading their recommendations should recognise their own team in the first one, and see a clear escalation of depth through the second and third.

02

Ordering Logic

Within each band, recommendations follow the same symptom-to-cause sequence as the questions themselves:

Position	Maps to	Logic
1st recommendation	Q1 / Q2: Meeting behaviour	Addresses what the respondent can see and change immediately. Quick win. Builds credibility.

2nd recommendation	Q3 / Q4: Process and decision design	Addresses the structural cause beneath the visible symptom. Requires process change, not just behaviour change.
3rd recommendation	Q5: AI and workflow maturity	Addresses the improvement lever. Positions AI adoption as the system that sustains the gains from recommendations 1 and 2.

03

Band 1: High Risk (Score 10–15)

A score of 10–15 indicates systemic coordination overhead across most or all five dimensions. The team has high-defect meeting patterns, low process discipline, low async maturity, unclear decision ownership, and minimal AI adoption. Recommendations address the most impactful structural intervention first, then process redesign, then the AI lever.

High Risk	Score 10–15	Systemic redesign required across meeting culture, process design, and AI adoption.
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1 Run a meeting audit: cancel everything, reschedule only what you miss

The fastest way to expose how much of your meeting load is structural habit rather than genuine need. Cancel all recurring meetings for two weeks. At the end of week two, only reschedule the meetings whose absence created a real problem. Research consistently shows teams eliminate 30–40% of recurring meetings through this exercise and rarely notice the gap. This is the entry point because it is visible, reversible, and produces immediate signal about where coordination overhead actually lives.

Ordering logic: Q1 score drives placement: status-update meeting culture is the most prominent symptom at this band	Source: Atlassian State of Meetings; Fellow.ai State of Meetings Report 2024
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2 Install decision ownership before any meeting gets scheduled

The root cause beneath most high-defect meeting patterns is the absence of a single named decision-maker. When ownership is unclear, decisions recirculate across meetings. Introduce a lightweight rule: every meeting invite must name one Accountable owner (using DACI or RACI logic) and state the decision or outcome expected. If either is missing, the meeting does not get scheduled. This single constraint restructures how work moves through the team without requiring a full process redesign.

Ordering logic: Q4 score drives placement: unclear decision ownership is the structural cause beneath Q1–Q3 symptoms	Source: DACI Framework (practitioner literature); RACI: Atlassian, Asana; APQC process benchmarks
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3

Deploy AI for post-meeting admin immediately: do not wait for a strategy

At a High Risk score, the team is spending the most time on the activities where AI produces the most reliable, measurable gains: meeting notes, action item extraction, follow-up drafting, and status summarisation. Start with one tool (Fathom, Fireflies, Otter, or equivalent) deployed consistently across all meetings. The goal is not AI transformation: it is eliminating the 60–90 minutes of post-meeting admin per meeting that currently consumes coordination capacity. Teams that do this consistently reclaim 4–6 hours per person per week within weeks, not months.

Ordering logic: Q5 score drives placement: zero AI adoption at maximum defect is the highest-leverage intervention point	Source: Noy and Zhang (MIT); Microsoft 365 Copilot data; Fathom/Fireflies adoption research; UC Today AI ROI 2026
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04

Band 2: Moderate (Score 5–9)

A score of 5–9 indicates clear friction in two or three dimensions but not across all five. The team has some process awareness: meetings are partially structured, some decisions have owners, some AI tools are in use. Recommendations target the gaps rather than the whole system.

Moderate	Score 5–9	Targeted fixes in 2–3 dimensions will produce measurable gains without full redesign.
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1

Standardise meeting formats with mandatory pre-reads

At a Moderate score, meetings are happening but inconsistently structured. The fix is not fewer meetings: it is better-prepared ones. Create two or three standard meeting templates: a decision meeting (agenda + named owner + context doc shared 24 hours in advance), a working session (problem statement + pre-work defined), and a review (artefact shared before, not during). Any meeting that does not fit a template gets rescheduled until it does. Research from Fellow.ai shows meetings with shared agendas run 25% shorter and produce clearer outcomes. This is a low-cost, high-visibility change that signals process seriousness without disrupting culture.

Ordering logic: Q2 score drives placement: inconsistent agenda discipline is the most common moderate-band pattern	Source: Fellow.ai State of Meetings 2024; Harvard Business School meeting preparation research; Worklytics 2025 benchmarks
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2

Shift information-sharing meetings to async by default

At a Moderate score, the team likely recognises that some of its meetings could be async but has not made the change. The friction is inertia, not intent. Introduce an async-first norm for all

information-sharing: weekly status becomes a Friday written briefing doc; project updates move to a shared Loom or Notion page; decisions already made are communicated in writing, not announced in meetings. Reserve synchronous time exclusively for decisions that require real-time negotiation. Teams that adopt this norm consistently recover 2–3 hours per person per week from information-sharing meetings alone.

Ordering logic: Q3 score drives placement: async substitutability recognised but unactioned is the defining moderate pattern	Source: APQC knowledge worker productivity benchmarks; Asana State of Work Innovation 2024; Atlassian async research
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3 Build shared AI workflows for the two highest-friction tasks

At a Moderate score, some team members are using AI individually but there is no shared system. Individual adoption creates uneven benefit and can increase inequality within the team. Identify the two most time-consuming repeatable admin tasks: typically post-meeting notes and internal status updates. Build a shared workflow for each. Document the workflow, assign an owner, and make adoption a team norm rather than an individual choice. The goal is not coverage: it is consistency. Two well-adopted workflows outperform ten individual experiments in terms of measurable time reclaimed.

Ordering logic: Q5 score drives placement: partial adoption without systematisation is the Moderate-band AI pattern	Source: McKinsey State of AI 2025; UC Today AI ROI 2026; Sana Labs AI productivity research
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05

Band 3: Healthy (Score 0–4)

A score of 0–4 indicates good process hygiene across most dimensions. Meetings are purposeful, decisions have owners, async norms exist, and AI tools are in use. Recommendations focus on protecting and compounding what is working, not on fixing defects.

Healthy	Score 0–4	Good process hygiene in place. Focus is on optimisation and protection, not redesign.
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1 Run a quarterly operating rhythm review to protect what is working

Healthy process hygiene degrades over time without active maintenance. Team composition changes, workload grows, and the norms that work at 10 people break at 25. Introduce a quarterly 60-minute operating rhythm review: audit every recurring meeting (is it still needed?), review decision ownership (are owners still clear?), and check async norms (are they holding?). Treat coordination overhead as a metric to be monitored, not a problem to be solved once. The teams that stay healthy are the ones that make process health a standing agenda item.

Ordering logic: Q1/Q2 scores drive placement: meeting discipline maintained is the leading indicator of sustained health	Source: APQC continuous improvement benchmarks; DMAIC control phase methodology; Worklytics 2025
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2 Document your decision architecture so it scales to new team members

Healthy decision ownership often exists as tacit knowledge: people know who decides what because they have worked together long enough to have learned it. This does not scale. Document your decision architecture: for the ten most common decision types in your team, name the Accountable owner, the Consulted stakeholders, and the expected turnaround. A one-page DACI reference doc removes the need for clarification meetings as the team grows and protects the decision velocity that is currently one of your competitive advantages.

Ordering logic: Q4 score drives placement: implicit decision clarity is fragile; making it explicit is the next maturity step	Source: DACI framework; RACI: Atlassian documentation standards; scaling team research
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3 Systematise your AI workflows and measure the gains

At a Healthy score, AI tools are in use but likely not yet systematised or measured. The next maturity step is to document what is working: which workflows, which tools, which team norms. Make them onboarding material for new team members. Then introduce a simple measurement: track hours per person spent on the three admin categories (meetings, comms, information retrieval) quarterly. This turns your AI adoption from an individual habit into an organisational capability that compounds as the team grows.

Ordering logic: Q5 score drives placement: consistent adoption without measurement is the ceiling of Healthy-band AI maturity	Source: McKinsey high-performer AI characteristics 2025; UC Today workflow ROI measurement framework
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06

Sources

- APQC: knowledge worker benchmark survey and continuous improvement research
- Atlassian: State of Teams; RACI and async work research
- Asana: State of Work Innovation Report 2024 (unproductive meeting load data)
- Fellow.ai: State of Meetings Report 2024
- Harvard Business School: meeting preparation and notice period research
- McKinsey: State of AI Report 2025 (high-performer AI workflow characteristics)
- Microsoft 365 Copilot: post-call admin time data (Quilter case study)
- Noy and Zhang (MIT): generative AI productivity study
- UC Today: AI productivity workflow ROI analysis 2026
- DACI Framework: practitioner literature and Umbrex documentation
- Worklytics: 2025 Productivity Benchmarks for Knowledge Workers